



In 2010, I was a Hillsdale College senior wondering what to do with my life. I was high on coffee one night, grabbed my notebook, and stayed up until sunrise.

I had drafted what would become Be A Number. Every t-shirt would have an Order Number on it, and every Number would belong to a real kid somewhere. Buy a shirt, a kid gets a shirt. You'd know exactly where it went.

By some Christmas miracle, it took off. Newspapers picked it up. I spent the next year traveling the country and the world handing shirts out.

That led me to Northern Uganda, where I planned to go bigger: every shirt connected to a specific child's education. You'd look up your Number and see the kid you were putting through school.

A month in, the agreement I'd flown over for collapsed. I fasted for the first time in my life, prayed about what to do, and decided to stay anyway.

The next years were a series of attempts to figure out the right version. A bakery in Gulu for women who'd escaped trafficking. A restaurant that ran five years. Microloans. Different partners. I watched what held and what didn't.

What held was a partnership with Wilobo Simon Peter, an Acholi man running work his own team designed, on his own land. Together we built what exists today: six acres in Omoro District, a school for 380 kids, a medical center, vocational training, and 30 people from the community employed to run it all.

The shirts are back. And because we run the school now, the original idea finally works the way it was supposed to. Every Number connects to a specific child you're helping put through class.

You're holding one of those Numbers. Thank you for that.

Ever,

Kevin Hershock

Founder, Be A Number